

Motivation & context

This typology aims at classifying new articles into 3-8 topics based on title and opening. Our end goal is to measure whether the news coverage of Chinese president & General secretary of the CCP Xi Jinping is mostly positive or negative on said topics.

When it comes to positive and negative we consider how the article portrays them →
The use of language and context.
It's about how the article portrays them

Categories

Definition of china: includes mainland china & territories actively controlled by the chinese state like honk hong, macao, tibet, (unless referring to those territories before they were under control of the chinese state). Exclude Taiwan and territories claimed by the Chinese state but not under their active control.

Domestic economic policy

Article focusing on decisions/policies principally affecting economic activity inside of China.

Positive Example : The Chinese Communist Party has long [thrived on secrecy](#), and 2024 was no different. As the year was ending, it became clear that Chinese President [Xi Jinping's](#) regime is pressing ahead with a [controversial plan](#) that will likely wreak environmental havoc by damming the world's highest-altitude river as it passes through Earth's largest canyon.

Negative Ex: U.S. authorities say Beijing established internment camps to detain Uyghurs and other Turkic Muslim minorities in Xinjiang. Beijing has denied any abuses, and says that its so-called "vocational education centres" were shut down in 2019.

The latest [tranche of sanctions](#) in January banned imports from 37 Chinese companies, including one of the world's largest textile manufacturers. Xinjiang officials last week admitted that U.S. sanctions had negatively impacted the local economy, causing unemployment due to firms' reduced ability to export. Xi was accompanied by Wang Huning, China's top official in charge of ethnic and religious affairs, and Cai Qi, his trusted chief of staff and China's number five official. In recent years, Chinese officials have sought to turbocharge the region's economic development to focus on manufacturing and clean tech industries, as well as heavily promoting domestic cultural tourism to the region.

Reasoning: although the article mentions impact of sanctions, the article's coverage focuses mainly on the treatment of Uyghurs in china rather than economic policy. The critic is not "This is bad economic policy" because of sanctions. This would fall under "Domestic social policy"

Foreign economic policy

Article focusing on decisions/policies principally affecting economic activity outside of China.

Positive example:

New data the Agriculture Department released Friday created serious doubts about whether China will really buy millions of bushels of American soybeans like the Trump administration touted last month after a high-stakes meeting between President Donald Trump and Chinese leader Xi Jinping.

Negative example:

Diplomatic relations

Article focusing on decisions/policies principally affecting china's relation with other countries, excluding matter specifically related to economic matter, social matter or military matter:

Positive Ex:

Xi Jinping pledges deeper ties during Thai king's first China visit

China's president says the two countries are like 'family', pledging to 'strengthen strategic alignment' with the Southeast Asian nation.

Negative Ex:

Chinese President Xi Jinping joins Donald Trump in skipping G-20 Summit (negative from canadian point of view)

New data the Agriculture Department released Friday created serious doubts about whether China will really buy millions of bushels of American soybeans like the Trump administration touted last month after a high-stakes meeting between President Donald Trump and Chinese leader Xi Jinping.

Reasoning: This as a diplomatic relations aspect, but is focusing on economics in the context of the trade war, This would fall under foreign economic policy.

Domestic social policy

Article focusing on decision policies principally affecting people's life inside china, excluding economics matter and non-chinese (includes immigrants in china, exclude foreigner like the 2 michael's accused of spying)

This would for example includes treatment of Uyghurs, Honk-Hong/covid protest, surveillance in china, treatment of worker etc.

Foreign social policy

Article focusing on decision policies principally affecting people's life outside China or non-chinese people inside or outside China, excluding economics matters. (This includes for example humanitarian actions, North Korean worker in china or on chinese boats, This would include surveillance of immigrants of Chinese origins in other countries but exclude surveillance of a Chinese citizen working abroad).

Military policy

Article focusing on the military, general use of force, weapons imports (weapon export would however fall under economic policy or diplomatic relations, unless they go to a proxy/are done in a military aid context). This would include spying if done mainly for military purposes, but exclude it if done for an economic/diplomatic/social purpose.

Biographic

Article focusing on the life of Xi Jinping outside of his responsibilities as a national leader/politician, including life of his friend & family.

Internal politics

Example

Article 65/501

TITLE: Will the Xi Jinping era come to a quiet end?

DESCRIPTION: A 'military mutiny' has already taken place, and a 'political coup' is underway.

SNIPPET: The so-called "Beidaihe Conference" does not actually exist, because it is not listed on the CCP's regular meeting agenda. In Beidaihe there are only irregular,...

Argument for comprehensiveness

That is the flowchart:

